

06/14 Common Ground Event

Agenda (Guiding timeline but doesn't need to be strict on time)

- **11:00-11:15 Welcome**

- Location: Welcome Womb
- People get situated, enter the garden
- Offer plant clips, name tag materials, and values list to newcomers
- Rent plant clips and give name tags to existing members

- **11:15-11:30 Garden + Greenhouse Introduction**

- Location: Welcome Womb. walk throughout the garden during the tour. land back into a location that fits everybody to be in a circle
- Kunal does tour and shares garden history
- Kunal shares garden guidelines and values
 - Garden Guidelines:
 - Welcome, this is a place of welcome and I'm happy to share more ways to get involved
 - Move at the speed of trust, slowly cultivate relationships with the land and neighbors
 - Embrace ephemerality
 - Each element to Temperance Alley Garden is a portal to a deeper story
 - Be mindful of the garden and do not step into the grow beds
 - Sarah shares greenhouse history, guidelines, and values
 - "Starting at the beginning of 2026, the intent of Greenhouse events is to share community space with others to meaningfully connect in growing emotionally, cognitively, and practically together. What values are really important to us that we want to commit to? What kind of lives do we want to lead? How do we grow closer to a more authentic version of ourselves? We explore these optics through discussion, creative activities, written prompts, and play. And it's a real pleasure to engage in these pursuits with you!"
 - "Some guidance as we run through these activities together:
 - ***RESPECT***: Treat yourself and others with consideration, dignity, and courtesy. We acknowledge experiences, opinions, and decisions, even if there is variance.
 - ***EXPRESS YOURSELF IMPERFECTLY***: We are all a work in progress. You do not need to have everything figured out to belong here. It's okay to be messy, uncertain, and to be continuously learning. You might feel some uncertainty about putting yourself out there, and I want to encourage you to try something new and share with us your authentic self.
 - ***LEAD WITH CURIOSITY***: Everybody comes with different experiences and perspectives. Explore new territory and ask

questions. Do not shame, dismiss, or belittle. Listen *intently and* learn more about others' perspectives.

- ***CARE FOR THE COLLECTIVE*:** This is a shared ecosystem. *Be* mindful of how your words, energy, and presence affects the space. We grow best when we tend to the whole garden, not just ourselves."

- **11:30-11:45 Garden Wandering**

- Location: People can wander the whole garden
- "Today, we are going to start off with being present as we engage in some garden wandering. I want you to really focus in on your environment and your experience in this garden. Feel free to journal and use the materials provided to note or draw out whatever comes up for you. This activity will end at 11:45, and we will also sound the chimes to indicate when it's time to come back to the group."
- Provide participants with a clipboard, paper with prompt, pencil
- Prompt:
 - While moving through the garden, notice what thoughts, feelings, observations, and/or memories come up for you. Do you feel any wind pushing against your skin? Is there a plant you see that intrigues you? Does any part of the garden bring you nostalgia, awe, boredom, peace, longing, etc.? Are you reminded of a garden you've been to before, a TV episode scene, a person you know who loves gardening? What does it feel like when you rub one of the leaves against your fingertips?

- **11:45-11:55 Brief Garden Wandering Reflection**

- Location: Circle up together again where there is space for everybody
- Sound the chimes to bring everybody back
- A couple people share their reactions
 - Prompts:
 - What came up for you after garden wandering?
 - Is there anything that surprised you?
- Let people know silence is okay and we can spend time sitting in it to process and reflect
- Collect clipboards, papers, pencils

- **11:55-12:10 Name Game**

- Location: Field past the Welcome Womb, where people can stand in a large circle
- Introduce the game
 - "Now that we've spent some time engaging ourselves in being present with the garden, let's have an official introduction and become present with each other."
- Select an alliterative adjective with your name and a gesture that goes with it (give 10 seconds to think on it)

- Everybody goes in a circle and shares their adjective, name, and gesture
- Everybody responds "Hey there ____ ____!" while doing the gesture to each person

- **12:10-12:30 Find Your People Game**

- Location: Field past the Welcome Womb, where people can stand in a large circle
- Introduce the game
 - "Now that we are acquainted with each other, let's learn more about some things that bring us together...through a game!"
- People will make a statement about something like, dislike, or perhaps a take "I don't like pineapple on pizza" (**Remind folks even though we're all friends now we still just met and the takes should be mindful of that**)
- Folks will then orient themselves in the space accordingly if you agree stand next to the person, and if you disagree go to the farthest others can stand somewhere in between
- We'll pause after each round to react and chat to each take and where people have situated themselves.

- **12:30-1:50 Circle Discussion**

- If more than 5-8 people, split people into groups
- Location: Space where everybody can sit down in circle(s)
- Discussion Prompts (Don't need to get to all if convo is flowing well):
 - What thoughts or feelings come up for you after doing the Name or Find your people activity?
 - Did you feel hesitant or a little strange about participating?
 - Did you feel present while participating in the games?
- Interlude:
 - "I can't express enough how grateful I am to everybody sharing what your experience was like, and for choosing to continue to show up and be here together in this space. It's special, it's meaningful, and I wouldn't want to be anywhere else other than present with you all this afternoon. Now continuing our conversation on presence..."
- Prompts:
 - What does it mean to you in general to be present with others?
 - In what moments of activities have you felt present before?
 - What takes you or has taken you out of being present?
- Interlude explanation:
 - "There are many benefits to bring in the here and now. Especially when our attention flicks across multiple sources, short-form media, and more, being anchored to the current moment has evidence-based advantages like reducing stress and anxiety, better focus, supporting the deepening of personal relationships, increased life satisfaction, and more. A concept related to presence is "embracing the temporary.""

- Discussion Prompts:

- What does the phrase "embracing the temporary" lead you to think?
- Does it feel familiar or uncomfortable to you to embrace the temporary, and why?

- **1:50-2:00 Wrap Up**

- Group photo
- Collect nametags and rented plant clips